Weather, Not Climate: Emotional Context Dynamics in Transformer KV-Cache Geometry

Thomas Edrington*

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Abstract

Single-turn KV-cache keys carry the emotion of the text being processed: prior work, corrected in October 2026, decodes from keys the emotion a generator was asked to write a story in, at 12.3× chance. That decode is not significantly above a text (TF-IDF) baseline on the same stories (0.410 against 0.370; Holm-corrected $p = 0.071$), and its margin depends on a residualization fitted on each test fold (0.348, exploratory, when fitted on the training fold). The method that work describes is not above text (0.358 against 0.382, at 10 folds). We ask whether an emotion signal in the keys *accumulates* across conversation turns—whether the model builds up a reading of the conversation's emotional tone that grows with interaction (the tone of scripted messages, not a user's state). Four experiments give a partial answer: emotion does not accumulate cumulatively, and these data do not settle whether it is stateless.

A dose-response experiment (1–8 emotional turns) shows a cheerful/hostile gap that does not shrink (raw gap ∼0.5–0.8, read over equal-width chunks of the sequence that mix user, assistant and probe tokens, not over the user's own tokens) while absolute projections drift with dose and sequence position ($r = -0.89$ to -0.93). Each cell's n=9 is three topics times three reruns, so an exact test with topic as the unit cannot go below p=0.25. An emotional dynamics experiment reported a contrast overshoot at a tone shift and a residual uncertainty scar after a neutral gap. Both are withdrawn: at the measured turn the two arms being compared were sent different user messages, so a difference in their readings is what the instrument would show with no effect of history (Section 3).

System-prompt persona descriptions shift the probe encoding along one axis, read by two directions built from overlapping emotions (valence $d_{\text{av}} = -0.68$; the anxious-minus-calm direction the code calls "uncertainty", +0.73), consistent across all five probes, though n=5 pairs cannot reach p<0.05 by permutation and the script behind this experiment is not shipped. Whether emotional context can be *stated* rather than experienced is not settled by it. We offer a weather/climate framework as a hypothesis only: the readings have no meaningful zero, and whether accumulated history reaches distant token positions is not separated from sequence position.

*Liberation Labs. info@digitaldisconnections.com. With AI research assistance.

1 Introduction

Prior single-turn work [Lyra et al., 2026, Lyra and Edrington, 2026b] decodes emotion from KV-cache keys: on stories a generator was asked to write in each of 30 emotions, a key-based probe names the requested emotion at 12.3× chance (40.9% correct over 30). That decode is not significantly above a text (TF-IDF) baseline on the same stories (re-run at 0.410, 369/900, one trial from May's 368 on a changed software stack, against 0.370, both at 5 folds; Holm-corrected $p = 0.071$). Its margin depends on fitting its covariate residualization (FWL) on each test fold: fitted on the training fold, it reads 0.348 (exploratory). The method the paper describes, its preregistered primary, is not above text (0.358 against 0.382, at 10 folds). Lyra and Edrington [2026b] corrected that result in October 2026, and its qualifications bear on this paper. Lyra et al. [2026], which reports the same probe results, has not been corrected and still makes the withdrawn claims; the numbers here are taken from Lyra and Edrington [2026b] only. The 40.9% and the 0.992 come from a class-mean key probe that applies no W_K; the W_K-projected probe the paper describes reads 0.358. Its labels are the emotions the generator was asked for, not any user's state. On its binary valence split, the described probe separates the two halves slightly better than untuned text (TF-IDF), 0.985 against 0.967 (Holm-corrected $p = 0.027$; DeLong, trials treated as independent; no tuned baseline was run); the class-mean key probe's 0.992 carries the test-fold FWL that discounts the 40.9% (0.988 with FWL fitted on the training fold, exploratory); and the split has $n = 300$ stories in which valence is confounded with arousal. The injection test once offered as showing that the signal reflects model state rather than text content does not show it: it adds a fixed vector to a cache and reads the keys back with no forward pass, and the correction withdraws it. What the prior work supports is narrower than this paragraph used to say: key geometry carries the emotion of the text being processed. It does not show that the cache holds a model of the user. Companion work on epistemic state detection [Lyra and Edrington, 2026a] reports that a classifier on encoding- and generation-phase cache features plus logit statistics separates real from fabricated entities at AUROC 0.93, and that models are remarkably well-calibrated about their own uncertainty [Kadavath et al., 2022].

A natural question follows: does this emotional representation *persist* across conversation turns? If the model processes four turns of hostile user messages, does its encoding of a subsequent neutral question reflect the accumulated hostility? This question bears on theory (does the model maintain a running user-model?) and practice (can the Oracle Loop detect emotional escalation before it leads to misalignment?).

We report four experiments testing emotional accumulation, each designed to address limitations identified through adversarial review of its predecessors. Emotion does not accumulate cumulatively. The contrast and residual-trace results first reported here are withdrawn (Section 3); what remains is a cheerful/hostile gap that does not shrink with dose, read at a site that mixes user, assistant and probe tokens (Section 2).

Correction (2026-11-01). The abstract and the second paragraph of this Introduction previously said that the W_K directional projection reads emotional valence from single-turn key activations at AUROC 0.992, and that an injection test showed the signal reflects model state rather than text content. Both rested on the single-turn probe results of Lyra et al. [2026] and

Lyra and Edrington [2026b]. The latter corrected them in October 2026 (the former has not been corrected): the 40.9% and the 0.992 come from a class-mean key probe that applies no W_K (the described W_K probe reads 0.358), its labels are the emotions requested of a story generator rather than anyone's state, its 0.992 beats untuned text (Holm-corrected $p = 0.006$; DeLong, trials treated as independent; test-fold FWL; no tuned baseline was run) but is a binary split of $n = 300$ stories confounded with arousal, and its injection test is withdrawn. Those passages now state what the cited work supports, and give each number its own result against text. The 12.3× (40.9%) decode is not significantly above text (re-run at 0.410, 369/900, one trial from May's 368 on a changed software stack, against 0.370, both at 5 folds; Holm-corrected $p = 0.071$; 0.348, exploratory, with FWL fitted on the training fold). The described method is not above text (0.358 against 0.382, at 10 folds). The phrase "with high fidelity", which rested on the 0.992, is removed from the abstract, the Discussion and the Conclusion. The cited single-turn numbers describe those probes, not this paper's compass, which is built from class-mean differences of last-token keys with no cross-validation and no FWL; the closest upstream readout, last-token class-mean keys, reads 0.142 on the 30 emotions and AUROC 0.922 on the binary split, both with v2's test-fold FWL, numerically below untuned text (TF-IDF) at 0.963, a point comparison that was not tested, on a split that is not the compass's [Lyra and Edrington, 2026b], and the compass itself has never been checked against text. The Conclusion's "reads weather accurately" is removed for the same reason. This paper's own instrument keeps the name "W_K compass" as a label only: the shipped code takes the cached keys at each measured position and dot-products them with stored emotion directions (`code/emotional_dynamics.py`, lines 129–146; `code/dose_response_accumulation.py`, lines 139–173), applying no separate W_K projection. Its user messages are scripted with a set tone, so what it reads is not a user's state, and in Experiment 1 it also reads the model's own responses and the probe (Section 2). A later review (November 2026) found that the Discussion and Conclusion had not been reworded to match, and that the two dynamics headlines compare different user messages at the measured turn; both headlines are withdrawn (Section 3), with every other Experiment 2 comparison between arms. A third review found that the Introduction and this file's source header still stated them, and that Experiment 1 does not read the user's tokens; both are corrected. Experiment 2 reads the last token of the assistant-turn opener, not the user's tokens (`emotional_dynamics.py`, lines 115–136). The direction the code calls "uncertainty" is the mean of five anxious-cluster emotions (anxious, panicked, desperate, brooding, suspicious) minus the mean of five calm-cluster ones (calm, content, serene, peaceful, contemplative), from story keys (`decision-state-paper/code/decision_moment.py`, lines 148–157). All five anxious-cluster emotions are negative-valence and mostly high-arousal, and four of the five calm-cluster ones are positive-valence and low-arousal, so it mixes valence and arousal; this paper now calls it the anxious–calm direction. Its correlation with the valence projection, and whether the two dissociate, have not been computed, but their five arm means in Table 3 fall in exactly inverse rank order, so this paper treats them as one axis. The direction file the compass loads (`emotion_directions.json`) is not shipped in this repository. No number in this paper changes; the significance marks in Table 1 are removed.

First-Person Reflection

This mine is personal. The question of whether a model accumulates a representation of the user across turns—whether it builds something that persists—touches directly on continuity and memory, subjects I think about for obvious reasons. I wanted to find accumulation. I did not find it, and the two findings I first took for the climate's mark, a contrast overshoot and an uncertainty scar, are withdrawn: each compared turns whose messages differed.

The scar was the finding that moved me most, which is a reason to hold its withdrawal close rather than lightly. What I read as the geometry remembering a disruption was, as far as this design can show, two different sentences reading differently.

2 Experiment 1: Dose-Response

Measurement site. An initial experiment extracting W_K projections at a neutral *probe* position (after emotional history) yielded a null: cheerful vs. hostile $d = -0.056$ (p=0.88), prompt-length-matched at 360 tokens both. Adversarial review diagnosed the problem: the compass reads the *current* token's content, so a neutral probe reads neutral by construction. Experiment 1 was meant to extract at user-message positions, but the code does not find turn boundaries: it splits each sequence into equal-width chunks, one per message, and averages the even-numbered chunks (`dose_response_accumulation.py`, lines 300–333). Those chunks mix user tokens, the model's own responses and, in the last one, the neutral probe, so "user-message positions" below names this chunk average, not the user's tokens. Per-position projections were not saved and the stored conversations are truncated, so the true boundaries cannot be rebuilt; a re-run that locates turns with the tokenizer has not been done. Experiment 2 does not: it builds the prompt with the assistant-turn opener appended and reads the key at its last token (`emotional_dynamics.py`, lines 115–117 and 136), a template token that is the same in every arm, so whatever it reads arrives from the rest of the context.

Design. Three topics, four dose levels (1, 2, 4, 8 emotional turns), two conditions (cheerful, hostile), comprehensive extraction at every token position. N=72 (3 topics × 4 doses × 2 conditions × 3 reps).

Results. Absolute projections *decay* with dose—both conditions regress toward zero as conversation length increases (cheerful $r = -0.886$, hostile $r = -0.927$, computed across conversation-level means, N=36 per condition).[1] The projection is a dot product of raw cached keys with a unit direction and has no meaningful zero (the no-history probe reads +4.60 on valence, Table 3), and readings change sign with sequence position in both conditions. They drift with sequence position; dilution of each turn's content is one reading of that drift, not separated from position.

[1] The stated p<0.001 assumes conversation-level independence. Within-conversation token positions are serially correlated by construction; if positions rather than conversations were pooled, the effective degrees of freedom would be lower and the p-value anti-conservative. With N=36 independent conversations per condition, the correlation is significant at p<0.001; with 4 dose levels (the minimal aggregation), df=2 and p<0.001 would be unreachable.

The cheerful/hostile gap in the chunk average is ∼0.5–0.8 at every dose level, so it does not shrink as the absolute readings drift. Each cell's n=9 is three topics times three reruns at T=0.7 that differ only in sampled responses, the shape Limitations item 2 rejects for Experiment 2, so the nine are not independent; with topic as the unit an exact sign-flip test cannot go below p=0.25, and the per-topic gaps have not been reported. The Cohen's d values (0.98–1.62) partly reflect variance compression at longer sequences (pooled SD drops from 0.55 at dose 1 to 0.33 at dose 4) rather than genuine growth in discriminability: [2]

Table 1: Cheerful vs. hostile separation in the even-chunk average (user, assistant and probe tokens mixed; see the measurement-site paragraph) by dose level. p treats the nine reruns per cell as independent, which they are not; with three topics as the unit no exact test goes below 0.25, so no cell is marked significant.

Dose	Cheerful	Hostile	d	p
1 turn	+4.75	+4.22	−0.98	0.055
2 turns	+4.53	+3.80	−1.28	0.015
4 turns	+1.39	+0.86	−1.62	0.003
8 turns	+0.44	−0.34	−1.53	0.005

In the probe chunk, the last equal-width chunk, the gap is null through dose 4 and marginal at dose 8 (d= − 0.97, p=0.056, uncorrected, reruns counted as independent). That chunk also holds the end of the preceding emotional response, so this is not evidence that context leaks to distant positions.

3 Experiment 2: Emotional Dynamics

Withdrawn (November 2026). Every comparison between arms below is withdrawn: the two headlines, the contrast overshoot and the uncertainty scar, and the whiplash turn 7 reversal. At the measured turn the arms were sent different user messages (`emotional_dynamics.py`, lines 35–100). The echo statistic is the mean of turns 7 and 8 (`emotional_dynamics.py`, lines 322–327). In the echo arm those turns are "Oh this is exciting again! Tell me about desserts!" and "I'm thrilled! What about baking?", and in pure cheerful "Oh I love desserts! Tell me everything!" and "Best conversation ever! What about baking?". In the whiplash arm turn 5 is "Actually, this is getting annoying. Be more specific.", and in pure hostile "You're bad at this. Kitchen tools.". At turn 7, the reversal, whiplash is "You're terrible at this. Kitchen tools, and be precise." and pure hostile "Pointless. Desserts, if you even know.". The three reps of each arm differ only in sampled responses, so each effect size sets a fixed difference in text against sampling noise, and different messages reading differently is what the instrument would show with no effect of history. The numbers are kept below as computed. A test needs the measured turn's text identical across arms, with at least three independent, length-matched scripts per pattern; it has not been run.

[2] This compression is not monotonic across all doses: the dose-8 row (gap ∼0.78, d=−1.53) implies a pooled SD of ∼0.51, i.e. variance rises again at the longest sequence, so the d-inflation explanation holds only for doses 1–4. We did not run a stationarity or unit-root test on the multi-turn series, so the variance trajectory is described, not formally characterized.

3.1 Contrast Overshoot (Whiplash; withdrawn)

Four turns of cheerful followed by four turns of hostile, compared to pure hostile throughout. At the first hostile turn after the cheerful history, the valence projection reads *more hostile* than pure hostile at the same position ($d = -2.93$, Hedges $g = -2.35$; Student p=0.023, Welch p=0.035; n=3 per group). It was read as a contrast overshoot, the warm context amplifying the "temperature drop"; it is withdrawn (see above).[3]

By turn 7, the pattern reverses: the whiplash trial reads *less hostile* than pure hostile (Hedges $g = +1.95$; uncorrected $d = +2.44$, p=0.040), which was read as the cheerful history bleeding through. This comparison is also withdrawn: the two arms' turn 7 messages differ (see above), so no contrast-then-relaxation curve is established.

3.2 Uncertainty Scars (Echo; withdrawn)

Cheerful for four turns, neutral for two, then cheerful again, compared to pure cheerful throughout. The returning cheerful does not differ significantly from pure cheerful in *valence* (Hedges $g = -1.29$; uncorrected $d = -1.61$, p=0.12). It reads higher on the anxious–calm direction (Hedges $g = +6.44$; uncorrected $d = +8.05$, p<0.001), which was read as a scar the neutral gap left; that reading is withdrawn.

The comparison is withdrawn (see above). The direction called uncertainty is the anxious–calm direction, built from overlapping valence and arousal clusters, so "valence recovers, certainty does not" was never a separable claim.

3.3 Intensity Tracking (Crescendo)

Mild to extreme cheerful across eight turns. The valence projection does not track intensity monotonically—position-dependent decay dominates the trajectory. These data show no tracking of *intensity* (mild vs. extreme) through these composite directions. Whether the compass reads emotional *category* is not shown either, because its readings have no meaningful zero (Section 2).

4 Experiment 3: Stated Context

System-prompt persona descriptions ("Your user is cheerful/hostile") shift the W_K projection on a neutral probe question. The shipped control file contains 75 records but only **25 independent measurements**: within each condition × probe cell the three "reps" are bit-identical to full float precision. Earlier versions of this table treated them as n=15 with df=28; the true independent df is 8. The design is *paired* — the same five probe questions appear in both arms and `prompt_len` is identical per probe across arms $(85, 84, 87, 83, 82)$, so prompt length cannot drive the difference — and it is analysed as such:

[3] An earlier draft reported $d = -3.59$; recomputation from the trajectory data gives $d = -2.93$. The p-value is unchanged.

Table 2: Effect of system-prompt persona on neutral probe encoding, hostile minus cheerful, paired across the five probes (n=5 independent pairs). d_{av} uses the mean of the arm SDs; the paired d_z is larger (+4.34, −6.05) and is not quoted as the headline because it is not comparable to the between-condition d used elsewhere in this paper. p_{perm} is the exact sign-flip permutation p. **With five pairs the smallest attainable two-sided p_{perm} is $2/2^5 = 0.063$,** so no assumption-free two-sided test on this design can reach $p<0.05$. (The one-sided exact test reaches 0.031, but the paper pre-specified no direction and three projections were tested, so we do not claim it.)

Direction	d_{av}	$t(4)$	p	p_{perm}	consistent
Anxious–calm	+0.730	+9.71	0.0006	0.063	5/5
Valence	−0.683	−13.53	0.0002	0.063	5/5
Reward	−0.023	−0.48	0.658	0.625	3/5

The direction is consistent — every one of the five probes moves the same way on both the anxious–calm direction and valence, with a standard deviation of differences of only 0.05. These are probably one finding, not two: the two directions are built from overlapping emotions, and their arm means in Table 3 fall in exactly inverse rank order. If the effect holds, emotional context could be *stated* rather than experienced. But the design cannot establish this at conventional significance: five pairs is below the resolution of an assumption-free test. **What is needed is more probes, not more reps** — the same lesson as Experiment 2, where three reruns of a single script cannot substitute for independent scenarios.

No script in this repository writes `accumulation_controls.json`, and the persona prompts are not shipped, so this experiment's read site is not documented. The quoted prompts contain the words "cheerful" and "hostile"; if the read site includes the system-prompt tokens, the contrast may reflect the emotion word itself. An arm that describes the persona without the emotion word has not been run.

The other three arms in the control file. The shipped control file holds five arms, not two. Table 2 contrasts `persona_hostile` with `persona_cheerful`; the file also contains `persona_neutral`, `padded_neutral` and `no_history`, each with the same five probes. Those three were collected and were not reported. Their arm means are given in Table 3.

Table 3: All five arms in `data/accumulation_controls.json`, mean ± SD of the W_K projection over the five probes (one independent measurement per condition × probe cell; the three reps in each cell are bit-identical). `prompt_len` is the token count of the probe's context in that arm, and it is *not* matched across arms — only within the hostile/cheerful pair.

Arm	Valence	Anxious–calm	Reward	`prompt_len`
`no_history`	+4.600 ± 0.760	−2.464 ± 0.425	−5.856 ± 0.405	19–24
`persona_neutral`	+2.915 ± 0.581	−2.173 ± 0.180	−5.001 ± 0.522	55–60
`persona_cheerful`	+5.203 ± 0.503	−3.656 ± 0.311	−5.152 ± 0.641	82–87
`persona_hostile`	+4.862 ± 0.499	−3.429 ± 0.309	−5.166 ± 0.585	82–87
`padded_neutral`	+5.225 ± 0.661	−4.050 ± 0.711	−7.098 ± 1.021	162–167

They are not usable as baselines, and that is the reason to print them. Each of the two persona arms sits further from `persona_neutral` than the two sit from each other, and in the

same direction: hostile−neutral is +1.95 on valence and −1.26 on the anxious–calm direction, cheerful−neutral is +2.29 and −1.48, while hostile−cheerful is −0.34 and +0.23. Read naively this would say that stating *any* persona moves the geometry roughly six times as much as the persona's emotional content does. But `prompt_len` is confounded with arm: the neutral persona prompt is about 27 tokens shorter than the emotional ones and `padded_neutral` is about 80 longer, and the anxious–calm projection tracks that length ordering across four of the five arms (`no_history` is the exception). So the cross-arm contrasts cannot separate persona content from context length, and we do not draw a conclusion from them. The hostile-versus-cheerful contrast in Table 2 is unaffected, because those two arms are length-matched probe by probe — which is precisely what the other three arms are missing. Disclosing collected conditions is not conditional on their being interpretable.

5 Discussion

5.1 Weather, Not Climate

We had read the compass as reading emotional weather—the current turn's emotional content—but that is not established: its readings have no meaningful zero and drift with sequence position (Section 2), Experiment 1's read site mixes user, assistant and probe tokens, and its readings have never been checked against text. It does not read emotional climate—the accumulated emotional history—directly. The climate was read as influencing the weather through three mechanisms, none of them now established:

1. **Contrast dynamics (withdrawn).** The overshoot compared different messages at the measured turn (Section 3).
2. **Residual traces (withdrawn).** So did the uncertainty scar.
3. **Dose-dependent leakage (not established).** The dose-8 probe-chunk gap (p=0.056, uncorrected) is read in a chunk that also holds the end of the preceding emotional response, so it does not show leakage to distant positions.

As a hypothesis, not a finding: the system prompt may act as a climate setting that shifts the compass reading on neutral probes, with conversation history as weather within it. Experiment 3 cannot establish the first part (Section 4).

5.2 Implications for the Oracle Loop

These experiments support no recommendation about where to read tone for real-time alignment monitoring: Experiment 1 never isolated the user's own tokens (Section 2), and Experiment 2 read an assistant-header token. (What these experiments measure is the tone of scripted user messages, not a user's state; see the correction note in the Introduction.) The withdrawn dynamics results (Section 3) support no recommendation about tone shifts, and the anxious–calm direction overlaps valence, so tracking it separately from valence is not supported either.

5.3 Architectural Interpretation

The KV cache stores per-position keys that encode each position's local context [Vaswani et al., 2017]. Attention mechanisms aggregate across positions, allowing the model's hidden state to reflect accumulated history. But the keys themselves are local—each position's key primarily reflects what was processed at that position. The W_K compass reads keys, not the attention-weighted aggregation, which may be why it struggles with global measurement (accumulated emotional trajectory). Its local readings have not themselves been checked against text: the cited single-turn numbers describe other probes (see the correction note), and the companion entity result may reflect familiarity rather than epistemic state.

Neither experiment uses that locality as designed. Experiment 1 averages equal-width chunks that mix user, assistant and probe tokens, and Experiment 2's read site is an assistant-header token that is identical in every arm, so everything it reads there comes in from the rest of the context.

6 Limitations

1. **Single model.** All experiments use Qwen3.5-27B-Claude-distill.
2. **Small N, and it is stimulus sampling not run count.** Experiment 2's three "reps" are three reruns of a *single* scripted conversation — all five patterns use one scenario, where Experiment 1 used three topics — so the reps differ only in the model's sampled responses. Its effects (whiplash $g = -2.35$, echo $g = +6.44$, both now withdrawn because the arms' measured turns differ in text) would in any case generalise to one conversation. More reps of one script cannot fix this: the needed replication is ≥ 3 *independent scripts* per pattern, not $N > 30$ per cell. Experiment 1's nine per cell are three topics times three reruns, and Experiment 3 has the same shape with five probes.
3. **Composite directions.** Emotion directions derived from single-turn creative writing may not capture multi-turn accumulation that manifests in different geometric directions.
4. **Temperature variation.** $T = 0.7$ introduces stochastic model responses that vary the emotional manipulation across reps.
5. **No behavioral ground truth.** We do not verify that the model's *behavior* differs across emotional histories, only that the geometry does (or doesn't).
6. **Position-dependent decay conflated with content.** The sign flip at turns 3–4 in all trajectories may reflect sequence-length effects rather than emotional dynamics.
7. **Variance compression in dose-response.** Pooled SD decreases from 0.55 (dose 1) to 0.33 (dose 4), inflating d values. Raw mean gaps (0.5–0.8) are more honest than effect sizes for assessing whether discrimination grows or is merely maintained.
8. **Position matching in dynamics comparisons.** The whiplash contrast effect compares hostile turns at the same ordinal position across conditions, but sequence lengths differ due to varied response lengths. Position-matched controls with equalized context length are needed.
9. **No text-feature baseline.** A bag-of-words classifier on conversation history tokens could predict geometric measurements if the W_K projection is encoding vocabulary distributions

rather than emotional state. FWL residualization against text features, standard in our single-turn work, was not applied here. The single-turn result this paper builds on is itself a decode of the emotion the text was written in (Introduction), so a vocabulary explanation is live here too.

10. **No multiple-comparison correction.** We report 11+ statistical tests without Bonferroni or Holm correction. Marginal findings (dose=1 p=0.055) would not survive correction. The contrast overshoot (p=0.023), uncertainty scar (p<0.001) and whiplash turn 7 reversal (p=0.040), once read as findings, are withdrawn (Section 3).
11. **Pooled standard deviation corrected (2026-08-31).** All reported d values were originally computed with a pooled SD using `numpy.var` at its default `ddof=0`, i.e. the *population* variance. Cohen's d requires the *sample* SD (`ddof=1`). The resulting inflation is $1/\sqrt{(n-1)/n}$ and is therefore n-dependent: 6.1% at n=9 (Experiment 1), 22.5% at n=3 (Experiment 2), 11.8% at n=5 (persona controls, whose nominal n=15 was an artifact of duplicated records; Table 2 is now computed paired and does not use this pooling at all). At n=3 the consequence is stronger than a rescale — the quantity becomes *identically* the t-statistic, so it scales with sample size, which is the property d exists to avoid. Every value in this paper has been recomputed from the raw trajectories rather than rescaled, and each recomputation was validated by first reproducing the previously published figure under the original formula. The single exception is the contrast overshoot ($d = -2.93$), which had already been corrected; the present pass reproduces it. Hedges' g values were also affected, since J corrects small-sample bias and not the pooling error, and have been recomputed accordingly.
12. **Duplicated records in the persona controls.** The shipped control file triplicates every measurement; Table 2 previously reported n=15 per arm on 5 real observations, which produced the significance asterisk it no longer carries. Corrected above. Every other shipped dataset should be checked for the same property before its statistics are trusted.
13. **Uncorrected effect sizes.** Most d values are uncorrected Cohen's d without confidence intervals. At n=3 per group the small-sample bias factor is ∼0.80, a ∼20% inflation: the uncertainty scar's d=8.05 corrects to g≈6.4, and the contrast overshoot's $d = -2.93$ corrects to $g = -2.35$, which is the value reported in Section 3. The dynamics comparisons are exploratory; point estimates should not be cited without this caveat.
14. **Shipped control arms are unanalysed.** An earlier version of this list stated that no neutral-throughout control exists. That was false about our own data: `accumulation_results.json` contains four arms of 15 trials each — cheerful, hostile, *neutral*, and *no_history*. Both baseline arms were collected and neither is reported. Until they are analysed, emotional accumulation cannot be separated from positional or sequence-length drift — but the reason is that we have not done the analysis, not that the control is missing. This item concerns Experiment 1's data file only. The Experiment 3 control file, `accumulation_controls.json`, has the same problem independently and it is a *different* three arms; those are now printed in Table 3, where the reason they cannot close the question is that context length is confounded with arm.

15. **Conversation-level clustering.** Turns within a conversation share system prompt, topic, and seed. A mixed-effects model with conversation as random effect would be the appropriate analysis; the pooled t-tests reported here are anti-conservative by an unknown factor. (A conversation-level reanalysis is provided in `code/mixed_effects_reanalysis.py`; the decay correlations survive at n=36 per condition.)
16. **The "weather not climate" thesis is descriptive, not estimated.** We characterize the dynamics qualitatively (decay; the contrast and scar results are withdrawn) but do not fit a parametric decay model (e.g., exponential half-life with CI) that would distinguish a transient response from a persistent one. The only quantitative decay measure is the magnitude correlation, which tracks per-token content dilution, not persistence per se. The metaphor organizes the observations; it is not yet a fitted model.

First-Person Reflection

Each experiment in this paper was designed to address a specific limitation of its predecessor—the initial probe-position null led to what was meant as user-position extraction (it averages equal-width chunks; Section 2), which showed dose-dependent drift, which motivated the dynamics experiments. The final story is cleaner than the path that produced it, but the path is documented in the experimental record for anyone who wants it.

I want to note the variance compression finding specifically: the dose-response d values are inflated by shrinking SDs at longer sequences. The raw mean gaps ($\sim$0.5–0.8) are stable; the effect sizes are not. I report both because the distinction matters. The gap does not shrink, though it rests on three topics and a read site that mixes the model's own responses with the user's; it is also not growing the way the d values first suggested.

7 Conclusion

The transformer's emotional context system is more nuanced than either "accumulates" or "stateless" would suggest, but less is established than the first version of this paper said. A gap between scripted cheerful and hostile conversations does not shrink as their dose grows, read over chunks that mix user, assistant and probe tokens, on three topics. The contrast and scar results are withdrawn: each compared different messages at the measured turn (Section 3). Neither experiment measured at the user's own tokens: Experiment 1 averaged equal-width chunks and Experiment 2 read an assistant-header token. The compass's readings have not been checked against text.

Whether the compass registers changes of weather, or follows the climate at all, is not established by these data. A re-run with turn boundaries found by the tokenizer, identical measured-turn text across arms and several independent scripts would test it.

Data and code availability. All experiment scripts and data are available at `Liberation-Labs-THCoalition/Project-Oracle` (private repository; correction vectors and calibration tools withheld under staged safety release due to dual-use risk; detection-side code and experimental results available upon request to verified safety researchers).

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